Apple Inc.

AAPL NASDAQ

Hold	$344.50 ▲ 0.45%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$360.00	$243.42 – $348.15	$5.03T

AAPL: All-Time Highs But Insiders Are Cashing Out

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL is grinding higher — up 0.45% to $344.50, now sitting at 97% of its 52-week range. No overnight news, no filings, just quiet melt-up on light volume (19.6M shares vs 38M+ earlier this week). That light volume on a new high is actually a yellow flag — it means buyers aren't exactly pounding the table up here.
- The real story is what's happening UNDER the hood: Tim Cook sold $50M+ of stock on October 2nd, and the General Counsel sold another $800K last week. When the CEO and the person who deals with regulators both sell at the top, pay attention.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm thinking: Apple is behaving like a defensive mega-cap right now — healthcare and staples led today (+2.5% and +1.15%), which usually means money is playing defense, and AAPL is riding that same "safety trade." But the options market is flashing a warning — massive put buying at the $342.50 and $345 strikes (nearly 8x normal open interest) means big money is paying up for downside protection RIGHT at current levels. Combine that with Cook dumping $50M of stock and you have a setup where smart money is quietly hedging while retail chases the new high. This doesn't mean crash incoming, but it does mean the risk/reward from $344 is not what it was from $280 — you're buying strength that insiders are selling into.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

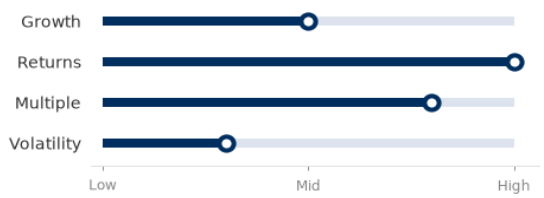
The biggest policy wildcard is the ongoing China tariff framework — Apple still manufactures ~85% of iPhones in China, and any escalation in the trade war directly compresses their margins (every 10% tariff on finished goods = roughly $0.30-0.40 of EPS hit). On the positive side, Apple got a de facto carve-out in the last round of tariffs because the administration doesn't want to spike iPhone prices into an election cycle — that political protection is real but not permanent. Also worth watching: the DOJ antitrust case on the App Store is still grinding through appeals, and the EU's Digital Markets Act is already forcing Apple to allow sideloading in Europe, which chips away at the 30% App Store tax that drives Services growth.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	**$344.50**
12M Price Target	**$360.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+4.5%**
Market Cap	**$5.03T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$420M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$450M**
FY2026E EPS	**$7.80**
FY2027E EPS	**$8.60**
Fwd P/E	**44.2x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

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PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$358.00**	$348.00	**$325.00**
6 Months	**$385.00**	$355.00	**$300.00**
1 Year	**$410.00**	$360.00	**$280.00**
2 Years	**$475.00**	$390.00	**$260.00**
5 Years	**$650.00**	$475.00	**$240.00**
10 Years	**$950.00**	$625.00	**$220.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+2.5%) and Staples (+1.15%) led today — classic defensive rotation, suggests institutions are getting nervous about growth/tech and parking money in safer names. Materials and Real Estate also strong, which hints at rate-cut expectations building.

COOLING OFF: Pure tech wasn't in today's top movers — that's notable. When defensive sectors lead and tech lags, it usually means the "risk-on" trade is tiring.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating from growth to defense without crashing anything — this is the "melt-up but hedge it" tape. AAPL benefits because it's increasingly viewed as a defensive mega-cap (sticky installed base, massive cash flow), but that reputation only holds as long as margins hold.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the AAPL thesis but want cheaper exposure, look at the suppliers — QCOM (chips), AVGO (Apple's wireless business), or SKWS. They move with Apple but trade at lower multiples. On the hedge side, if you're worried about China tariffs, FXI puts give you cheap insurance.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Winning the enterprise AI race through OpenAI partnership and Copilot monetization — a cleaner AI story than AAPL right now
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Gemini traction plus regulatory overhang finally priced in — trades at a cheaper multiple than AAPL with faster growth

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is keeping up with Mag 7 peers on price but LAGGING on narrative — it's not leading the AI conversation, which matters because that's where the multiple expansion is coming from in big tech. If AAPL doesn't have a clear AI story by WWDC 2027, the premium multiple becomes very hard to defend.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: $320-330 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: China tariff escalation that hits iPhone margins >300bps, or Services growth drops below 8%

Hedging: Buy near-the-money puts for 1-2% of position — cheap insurance given low volatility

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